

GETTING UNDER THE HOOD

Now it's time to get your hands dirty. Read on as we walk you through the install process, the various GUI options and some Command Line wizardry.

You've read about how Linux is making massive strides in nearly every sphere of computing, from supercomputers and servers to embedded devices and smartphones, and you've read about how this might just be the "Year of the Linux Desktop". Hopefully we've convinced you to give Linux another shot, and in this chapter we're going to tell you exactly how.

Most Linux distributions come in the form of a Live disk - either a CD/DVD or an image on a pen drive that can be booted off. You can experience the Operating System first-hand without making any changes to your hard drive, whatsoever. You can browse the web, access documents and media files on your hard drive, install applications, perform some configuration and generally fool around with the knowledge that your primary OS lies secure